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Last week: **DJIA** 46190.61 ▲ 711.01 1.56% **NASDAQ** 22679.97 ▲ 2.1% **STOXX 600** 566.24 ▲ 0.4% **10-YR. TREASURY** ▲ 12/32, yield 4.006% **OIL** \$57.54 ▼ \$1.36 **EURO** \$1.1655 **YEN** 150.63

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Activist investor** Jana has built a stake in medical-device maker Cooper and will seek a potential deal to merge its contact-lens unit with rival Bausch + Lomb. **B1**

◆ **Kering is in talks** to sell its beauty business to L'Oréal in a deal that values the division at roughly \$4 billion, in a move aimed at reviving the luxury giant's fortunes. **B1**

◆ **A worker's discovery** that \$50,000 of her contributions to her 401(k) account were missing highlights a hidden risk in employer-provided retirement plans. **A1**

◆ **The automotive industry** is again being rattled by supply-chain problems, this time as companies face major tariff hits and make a pivot away from electric vehicles. **B1**

◆ **Amid an unsettling** market stretch, investors are turning to stocks in healthcare, consumer staples and other sectors that reliably make profits no matter economic conditions. **B1**

◆ **China's economy** faces a crisis of 'involution,' a cycle of competition so fierce that it is destroying profits, driving a worker rat race and fueling a deflationary spiral. **A18**

◆ **Startups from Silicon Valley** and beyond are racing to develop cheap, reliable systems to counter hostile drones that are appearing far from the war in Ukraine. **A18**

◆ **Outsourcing-services** company Provalus is undergoing a rapid expansion by investing in rural communities where hiring otherwise lags. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **Israel conducted** dozens of airstrikes in Gaza and halted humanitarian aid after it accused Hamas of killing its troops, in a major test of the fragile cease-fire. **A1**

◆ **The window** for extending billions of dollars in Americans' healthcare subsidies is closing rapidly, as Democrats insist on a deal as a condition for ending the government shutdown. **A1**

◆ **The nationwide 'No Kings'** protests against Trump drew a heavy turnout in a peaceful show of opposition to what demonstrators call an authoritarian takeover. **A6**

◆ **Robbers broke into** the Louvre Museum in Paris in broad daylight and made off with eight pieces from a gallery of priceless crown jewels. **A8**

◆ **Bolivia elected a centrist** who seeks improved U.S. relations as president, ending two decades of socialist rule. **A9**

◆ **Trump said the U.S.** would cut off aid to Colombia after that country's president accused Washington of homicide over a recent boat strike. **A9**

◆ **The U.S. is repatriating** two people to Colombia and Ecuador after they survived an American strike on a submersible. **A9**

◆ **Hundreds of communities** across the U.S. have successfully fought proposed FEMA flood maps that restrict development and mandate insurance, despite the risks involved. **A3**

◆ **Over 20,000 ads** have aired this year that focus on transgender sports or bathrooms as the GOP relies on the culture-war theme in elections. **A4**

JOURNAL REPORT

Wealth Management: Getting more workers to buy annuities. **R1-10**

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In Daylight Raid, Thieves Steal Jewels at Louvre



QUICK HIT: A portable furniture elevator remained outside the Louvre Museum in Paris on Sunday, after thieves burst in through a window of a second-floor gilded gallery and made off with priceless royal jewels in broad daylight, all in just minutes. **A8**

Congress Running Out of Time To Decide on Health Subsidies

WASHINGTON—The window for extending billions of dollars in Americans' healthcare subsidies is closing rapidly.

By Lindsay Wise, Anna Wilde Mathews and Katy Stech Ferek

Enhanced Affordable Care Act subsidies are set to end after this year unless Congress acts, and open enrollment for insurance next year

starts next month. Democrats have demanded that Republicans negotiate on extending the subsidies as a condition for ending the government shutdown, now in its third full week. Republicans recognize that many of their voters will be hurt by a cutoff in tax credits, but they say the program known as Obamacare needs major changes.

Any deal to end the shutdown is expected to involve a fix for the expiring ACA sub-

dies, which flow to more than 20 million people. But extending the enhanced subsidies would be difficult to swallow for Republicans in Congress, who have spent the past decade and a half railing against the 2010 law that passed—and was later expanded—with only Democratic votes.

“Actually being able to write something that can be put in effect between now and Nov. 1? I don’t know how it gets done,” said Sen. Mike

Rounds (R., S.D.). “There are fundamental differences between what Republicans want and what Democrats want on this issue.”

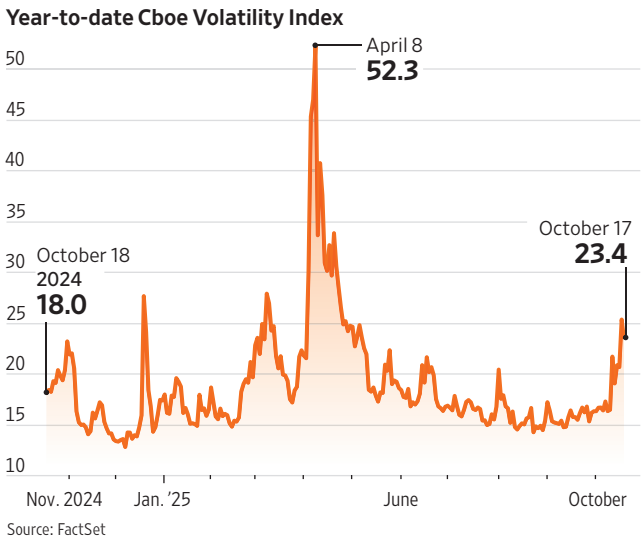
The fight is the latest turn in the Obamacare saga, which keeps re-emerging as one of Washington’s most intractable policy conflicts.

Democrats are convinced their party is well positioned to win this fight. Polling has shown strong support for con-

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For Stocks, Volatility Is Back

Investors are shifting to defensive sectors such as utilities, healthcare and consumer staples, but also bonds and gold, as the U.S. and China have amped up trade-war rhetoric. **B1**



There Are Lots of Michelin Stars, But Only One Porridge Champion

Contestants travel to Scottish Highlands to vie for world crown; so much can go wrong

By JAMES HOOKWAY

CARRBRIDGE, Scotland—There are all sorts of ways to make porridge. You can heat it low and slow or take it to a soft gloopy boil. It can be stirred gently or with a bit more oomph. The salt could come from the Himalayas or the salt pans off Scotland’s west coast, the oats from nearby farms or as far as Australia.

But there is one thing the experts say you should always do, and that’s stir the porridge clockwise.

“If you don’t, you’ll let the devil in and it will be ruined,” said Charlie Miller, who for years organized the Golden Spurtle, the world porridge making champion-

ship held in this village deep in the Highlands.

For 32 years, competitors have come from around the globe armed with their spurtles, the tapered sticks Scots use to stir their oats, to see what they can conjure up in their pots in the allotted 30 minutes. It seems simple enough. In its traditional form there are just three ingredients to porridge: water, oats and salt.

Yet so much can go wrong. It can be too runny, too clumpy, too salty, not salty enough, burned, sticky and, frankly, not very good at all. There is a reason it’s what prisoners were routinely fed in Britain, so much so that a stretch in jail was known as *Please turn to page A8*

Antidepressants Are Recast As Hot Lifestyle Accessory

Influencers tout them, but side effects dismay many followers

Corinne Byerley, a stay-at-home mom, recalled days when she felt lonely, overwhelmed and, at times, paralyzed with anxiety and self-doubt.

By Betsy McKay, Shalini Ramachandran and John West

Byerley, who had neither health insurance nor money for psychotherapy, said she was intrigued hearing a former MTV star talk up Lexapro on a podcast in 2023. She searched for the drug on TikTok, her go-to information source, and found #lexaprotok and similar niche online communities, where women in their 20s and 30s praised the benefits of antidepressants.

She posted a video asking for help, and someone recommended Hers, a telehealth company. Byerley answered a questionnaire, and an online nurse practitioner prescribed a generic version of Lexapro. A bottle arrived days later.

Byerley, of Canton, Texas, posted TikTok videos of herself running to the mailbox for a pill package and taking a dose, using such hashtags as #lexaprobaddies and #gethelp-mama. In the months that followed, she gushed over the pills to her thousands of followers. “My medication quieted the noise I’d suffered through for years,” she said in one video.

For a time, Byerley belonged to a social-

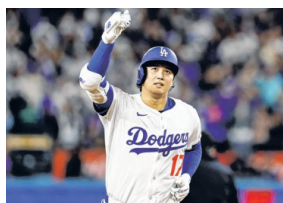
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INSIDE



U.S. NEWS

New diet advice from RFK Jr.’s MAHA is likely to embrace saturated fat. **A3**



SPORTS

Shohei Ohtani has an all-time game as the Dodgers advance to the World Series. **A14**

Missing 401(k) Funds Show a Hidden Risk

By ANNE TERGESEN

Amanda Otter was used to her 401(k) balance fluctuating with the markets. But when she logged into her account one day, she discovered the value was down for another reason: some of her retirement savings were missing.

Her employer had deducted a couple of thousand dollars from her paycheck in early 2022 to put into her retirement account, but less than half that amount was transferred over. A lot more cash would eventually vanish. Otter embarked on a three-year hunt that laid bare just how difficult it can be for employees to recover missing 401(k) money.

Her company, Information Technology Partners, and its president kept promising the situation would be fixed, former employees said, although

lawsuits show the company was slowly unraveling. The Labor Department, which regulates employer-sponsored 401(k) plans, told her it was investigating, but little more.

Otter, a 54-year-old web designer in Redlands, Calif., said she assumed the money was missing because of an oversight, so she didn’t pause her 401(k) contributions. But she demanded answers from company officials in a barrage of emails. “I was the squeaky wheel,” Otter said.

Her missing contributions ultimately ballooned to over \$50,000, including the investment returns she would have earned, according to her payroll and 401(k) records.

Michael Thompson, who was the president of Information Technology Partners, couldn’t be reached for comment after several requests *Please turn to page A2*

Israelis Hit Gaza Targets, Interrupt Aid Flow

Military says Hamas attacked its troops, which group denies; test for cease-fire

By DOV LIEBER AND ANAT PELED

TEL AVIV—Israel conducted dozens of airstrikes across Gaza on Sunday and halted humanitarian aid into the enclave after it accused Hamas of killing troops inside Israeli-controlled areas in what is shaping up to be the biggest test yet of the fragile cease-fire.

The Israeli military said two soldiers were killed in southern Gaza, where militants targeted troops inside Israeli-controlled areas with an antitank missile and gunfire. Another soldier was severely injured, the military said.

Hamas made two other attempts to attack Israeli soldiers Sunday, the military said.

Israel decided to halt humanitarian aid following calls from Israeli politicians across the political spectrum for Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to respond forcefully to the attack against troops.

Signaling an end to its response, Israel’s military said Sunday evening that it had begun reinforcing the cease-fire after the airstrikes.

Hamas’s armed wing, the al-Qassam Brigades, denied mounting any attack on Israeli troops on Sunday and said contact with its fighters in Israeli-controlled southern Gaza has been cut off since March.

“We affirm our full commitment to implementing everything that was agreed, foremost among which is a

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